



Plants for waterlogged sites

Gardens prone to waterlogging provide conditions similar to those on the margins of a natural pond where bog plants thrive (see p.54 and p.164).

While most plants dislike wet feet for long periods of time, there are some, such as *Acorus*, *Gunnera*, and *Taxodium*, that thrive happily in such conditions. If your soil is intermittently waterlogged, consider choosing plants such as hostas, sedges (*Acorus* and others), kerria, and *Leycesteria*, that will tolerate a wide range of conditions. If you seek to improve your soil structure and open up air and drainage channels, dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost, together with horticultural grit. Also cover the surface with an organic mulch annually.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Astilbe x arendsii

ASTILBE This bog plant is a clump-forming perennial that thrives in waterlogged conditions. It produces deeply divided, dark green fernlike foliage and feathery plumes of white, pink, lilac, or red flowers from early- to late summer.

↑18in (45cm) ↔12in (30cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–8



SHRUB MEDIUM

Cornus sericea

TWIG DOGWOOD This shrub is grown for its stunning red winter stems, bright yellow-green in varieties such as 'Flaviramea' (above). The dark green lance-shaped foliage turns orange and red in fall. Cut old stems to the ground in late winter.

↑6ft (2m) ↔12ft (4m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z2–8 (N)



PERENNIAL LARGE

Aconitum napellus

MONKSHOOD A beautiful upright perennial for wet soils, it has deeply cut dark green foliage and tall spikes of indigo-blue blooms from mid- to late summer. The tall stems may need staking. All parts are toxic if ingested; wear gloves when handling it.

↑5ft (1.5m) ↔12in (30cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–8



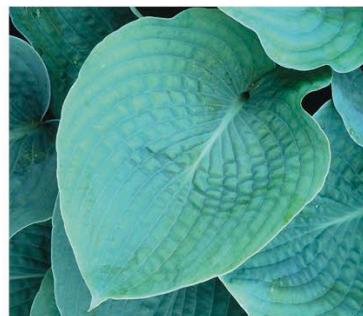
PERENNIAL LARGE

Actaea racemosa

BLACK COHOSH Useful for waterlogged soils, this perennial bears a combination of deeply cut leaves and bottlebrush-like spikes of white midsummer flowers. The dried brown seedheads extend the season of interest. Grow at the back of a bed.

↑up to 5ft (1.5m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–8 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Hosta sieboldiana

PLANTAIN LILY This medium-sized leafy perennial is tolerant of waterlogged soils and shade. It features large, rounded rich blue-green leaves with a puckered texture. Spikes of lilac-tinged white flowers appear in early summer. Protect from slugs.

↑3ft (1m) ↔4ft (1.2m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–9



SHRUB MEDIUM

Hydrangea macrophylla

LACECAP HYDRANGEA This broad-leaved shrub grows well on clay soils and tolerates occasional waterlogging. From midsummer to early fall, it bears tiny flowers with petal-like florets. Other forms have white, pink, purple, or, on acidic soils, blue blooms.

↑6ft (2m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z6–9



SHRUB LARGE

Hydrangea paniculata

PANICLE HYDRANGEA This shrub adds color to beds with waterlogged soils. It has strap-shaped foliage and beardless lilac-pink flowers with gold marks on the lower petals from early- to midsummer. Considered invasive in some Northeastern areas.

↑↑10ft (3m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–8